hour before the opening time of the office.

b) The office manager should see to it that the work in the office start immediately after opening of the mail, otherwise the time and money spent on an early opening of the mail would be wasted.

c) The staff incharge for opening the mail should be fully conversant with the method of sorting and opening the mail. If possible, a mailing manual should be used in this regard.

d) After an envelope has been opened, it is necessary to remove the content from it. Empty envelopes should be fastened by a pin or clip or stapler.

4. **Scrutiny of Contents:** After the removal of the contents, it must be scrutinised to find out for whom and for which department, they are meant for. The sorting of letters has been done on a departmental basis at this stage. Before sending the mail to the concerned departments, the enclosures to the letters should be checked, compared and verified with the covering letter to find out whether they are in order or not. Occasionally, the enclosures may be a cheque, bank drafts, postal order or a valuable document. If any discrepancy or omission is found while scrutinising, then the matter should be immediately brought to the notice of the mailroom supervisor. Letters in which certain previous references are given may be sent to the filing department from where the letters and the relevant files may be sent to the concerned department.

5. **Stamping the Mail:** After proper scrutiny is done, the date of stamping the letter must be done. Sometimes the date and time of receipt would be stamped on the letter. For stamping of letters, a stamp is prepared which contains the serial number, the date of receipt and time of receipt if necessary. A reference stamp is attached if the letter relates to number of departments. A design of specially design stamp is given below.

S.K. AKILA STATIONERY MART
NO ---------- DATE ----------
RECEIVED ----------
PACKED ----------
REPLIED ----------
FILED ----------

Format of Stamp

6. **Recording the Mail:** After the stamping work, letters received are recorded in inward mail register or letters received book. Before recording of letters in the register, the contents are scrutinized properly so as to ensure the department to which it belongs. The inward mail register contains 1. Serial number 2. Date of receipt 3. Senders name and address 4. Nature of contents 5. Subject of the letter in brief 6. Remarks and initials of the officer with date.

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